FLORIDA Luxury REALTY

THE ROUND TABLE PLAYBOOK

Holiday Business Playbook

Securing Buyer and Seller Business Through Year-End

Scripts, objection answers, listing tips and
Amendment 3 talking points to use with real clients.



PRESENTED BY

Scott Barrett

Broker, Florida Luxury Realty

PLAN THROUGH DEC 31

INSIDE THIS PLAYBOOK

Contents

START HERE **Introduction: Securing business between now and December 31** 3

CHAPTER 1 **Seller conversations** 4

- The invitation 4
- The objection: "Let's wait until January" 4
- Two more seller objections 5

CHAPTER 2 **Buyer conversations** 6

- The invitation 6
- The objection: "I'll wait until after the holidays" 6
- Two more buyer objections 7

CHAPTER 3 **Listings taken during the holidays** 8

- The holiday photo plan 8

CHAPTER 4 **Florida Amendment 3** 9

- How Amendment 3 can benefit this holiday 9
- Explaining December 31 carefully 9
- Residency, ownership and homestead are separate steps 10
- Can't close by December 31? How an out-of-state buyer can establish Florida residency 10

CHAPTER 5 **Marketing, discussion and your commitment** 11

- Choose one personal outreach per client 11
- Discussion: share a real client scenario 11
- Complete this sentence out loud 11
- Tool tip: Hynri social posting 12

START HERE

Introduction: Securing business between now and December 31

This playbook shows you how to secure buyer and seller business between now and December 31. It gives you the scripts, objection answers, listing tips and Amendment 3 talking points to use with real clients.

A question to start. A seller says, "Let's wait until January." A buyer says, "After the holidays." What do you say? Bring a real client, with no names, and leave with words you can use today.

The outcome. By the end, each agent leaves with three things:

1. **Priority clients.** A short list of the clients you will help before year-end.
2. **One conversation.** One buyer or seller conversation you will schedule.
3. **A follow-up plan.** Clear next steps that run through December 31.

What this playbook covers. Seller conversations, buyer conversations, tips for listings taken during the holidays, Florida Amendment 3 and residency, and marketing and commitments.

CHAPTER 1

Seller conversations

Start with the seller's goals and timeline, not the holiday calendar. The aim is a calm, helpful next step, never a pitch.

The invitation

Practice this out loud with a partner, then adapt the wording to one real seller:

> *"You mentioned a move may be coming up. Would it be useful to look at what selling during the holidays could involve, alongside waiting until January? We can compare likely competition, recent neighborhood sales, preparation time, and your preferred move date before you decide."*

Visiting family can also open the door, as an invitation and not a sales pitch:

> *"If you have friends or family visiting who are curious about the area, I'd be glad to show them around or answer questions. And if selling is on your mind, we can also map out a plan that fits your timing."*

The objection: "Let's wait until January"

Respect the choice, then compare the two timelines. Here is the answer:

> *"That may be the right choice. Could we compare the two timelines first? Between now and December 31, fewer homes are coming to market, so there is less new competition. In January, many more sellers list. With plenty of homes already for sale, let's look at the local numbers together and decide with the tradeoffs in front of you."*

The reasoning behind it: between now and December 31, fewer new homes come to market, so a seller faces less new competition. In January many other sellers enter, which means more

competition and less opportunity, and the market already has a large inventory of active homes for sale.

Two cautions. Do not promise a sale, a price or a timeline. And check current local inventory, new-listing counts and recent comparable sales before you make this case, then show those numbers to the seller.

Two more seller objections

Keep the first step small.

"The holidays are too busy."

> *"I understand. We can keep the first step small: a brief pricing and preparation conversation, with no commitment to list. If the timing doesn't work, we'll plan for later."*

"I don't want people coming through my home."

> *"That's a reasonable concern. We can talk through your comfort level, showing schedule, privacy, and whether a later launch makes more sense. You set the limits."*

CHAPTER 2

Buyer conversations

With buyers, start with the timeline: are they ready to act, or mainly gathering information? Neither answer is wrong, and you do not need to assume anyone has to buy now.

The invitation

> *"If you found a home that fit your needs and budget, would you be ready to consider it before year-end, or are you mainly gathering information? I can help you compare the costs, timing, and tradeoffs without assuming you need to buy now."*

For buyers visiting or relocating, the holidays are a chance to learn the area:

> *"If you'll be in Florida over the holidays, we can use the visit to explore neighborhoods and get a realistic sense of prices, commute, and day-to-day life. We can also speak with a lender early if you want to understand your options."*

The objection: "I'll wait until after the holidays"

Respect the choice, then bring in the seller's side of the table:

> *"That's an option. Many sellers have a goal of selling by year-end so they can start the new year in their next home, and that can make them more motivated to reach an agreement now. Would it help to see which homes are available and what a year-end offer could look like?"*

Many sellers can picture themselves moving to their next destination in the new year, and meeting that personal goal can make them more motivated to agree to a contract close to year-end. Four suggestions help you use that honestly:

- Ask listing agents about the seller's timeline and goals.
- Offer flexible closing or move-out dates.

- Compare terms, not only price.
- Keep it honest. Never pressure the buyer.

Seller motivation varies and is never guaranteed, so do not promise a discount. If the buyer still decides to wait, agree on a clear plan for when to restart, and compare what waiting means for their lease, move date and financing.

Two more buyer objections

The key is to separate the home decision from the tax decision.

"I'm worried about rates or prices."

> *"Those are real considerations. I can help you compare homes and timing, and a lender can explain payment scenarios. We shouldn't assume rates or prices will move in your favor, so let's focus on what works for your budget and plans today."*

"I'm not sure Florida is permanent."

> *"Then let's separate the home decision from any tax decision. We can explore whether buying makes sense for your plans, and you can confirm residency and tax questions with the county property appraiser or a qualified tax professional."*

CHAPTER 3

Listings taken during the holidays

A listing taken in November or December has one extra enemy: the decorations. Three habits protect it.

- **Photos first.** Photograph the home before holiday decorations go up.
- **Keep it light and neutral.** Show the home, not the holiday. Simple, minimal décor.
- **Be flexible.** Offer evening, weekend and virtual walkthroughs around family plans.

The holiday photo plan

A holiday-decorated home in the marketing dates the listing and pulls attention from the house. If the photos can be taken before decorations go up, take them then. If not, follow this plan.

1. **Shoot first.** Schedule photos before the decorations go up, ideally before the listing goes live.
2. **Tone it down.** If décor is already up, ask the seller to remove or minimize it for the shoot.
3. **Reshoot later.** If that is not possible, list with the best photos available and reshoot as soon as the decorations come down.
4. **Replace everywhere.** Swap the new photos into the MLS and all marketing the same day.

Marketing includes social posts, flyers, your website and virtual tours or video. Tell the seller the plan up front so there are no surprises, and follow your MLS rules and brokerage policy when replacing photos.

CHAPTER 4

Florida Amendment 3

Florida voters approved Amendment 3 in November 2026, and it takes effect January 1, 2027. These are talking points, not tax advice. Results were unofficial, and some details may need legislation in 2027.

How Amendment 3 can benefit this holiday

- **Bigger homestead exemption.** For non-school property taxes, the exemption rises to $150,000 for 2027 and $250,000 for 2028, with inflation adjustments after that.
- **Some bills stay the same.** School taxes and flat non-ad valorem charges are not eliminated. Savings vary by property.
- **A residency-related phase-in.** Summaries describe a smaller non-school exemption for people who did not have a Florida permanent residence on December 31, 2026. Confirm how it applies with the county property appraiser.
- **Timing.** The change starts in 2027, which is why December 31, 2026 is a date worth discussing.

Explaining December 31 carefully

Say it this way:

> *"If you're genuinely moving your permanent home to Florida, December 31, 2026 may matter under the new amendment's residency rules. Buying a property alone does not necessarily establish Florida residency or qualify it for homestead. Let's connect you with the county property appraiser or a tax professional to confirm what applies to you."*

Avoid saying:

- Every out-of-state buyer must buy by December 31.
- Buying alone secures the benefit.
- Homestead starts the day you close.
- A specific tax saving is guaranteed.

Residency, ownership and homestead are separate steps

1. **Own and live in it.** A buyer generally must own and occupy the home as a permanent residence as of January 1.
2. **Apply on time.** Apply with the county property appraiser by the filing deadline, commonly March 1.
3. **Confirm local rules.** Check current county rules and how Amendment 3's residency provisions apply.

Buying a property alone does not establish Florida residency.

Can't close by December 31? How an out-of-state buyer can establish Florida residency

The December 31 test is about permanent residence in Florida, not owning the eventual home. Law-firm summaries say a person who genuinely establishes Florida permanent residence by December 31, 2026, including while living in a leased or other residence, would generally be eligible for the larger exemption once they later own, occupy and apply for homestead on a Florida home.

1. **Live in Florida by December 31.** Rent, or live with family or friends. No lease is needed, but Florida must be the real permanent home. A signed lease alone does not prove residency. When staying with someone else, keep evidence such as mail, bills, and bank and license records at that address.
2. **Document the move.** Evidence that may help includes recording a declaration of domicile with the clerk of court, a Florida driver license (giving up the old one), Florida voter and vehicle registration, and moving mail, banking, tax and employment records. No single item is conclusive, and old-state ties can undercut the claim.
3. **Close and move in.** Buy after December 31 and occupy the home as the permanent residence.
4. **Apply for homestead.** Own and occupy as of January 1, then apply with the county property appraiser by about March 1.

One point to say plainly: closing after January 1 usually means homestead starts the following tax year, so do not promise the benefit immediately after closing. Implementing legislation may also set how residency is proven as of December 31, 2026. Refer buyers to the county property appraiser, a Florida attorney or a tax professional.

Sources: Holland & Knight (hklaw.com, Nov 2026), Bilzin (bilzin.com, Sep 2026), Roulet Law (rouletlaw.com).

CHAPTER 5

Marketing, discussion and your commitment

Choose one personal outreach per client

For each priority client, pick one useful, personal message and keep it specific to that person's plans. Four examples:

- **Market update.** "Would a quick neighborhood update help with your planning?"
- **Holiday visit.** "Want to use your holiday visit to compare a few areas?"
- **January seller.** "Would you like a sale-preparation checklist, even if you're targeting January?"
- **Lender or county.** "Would it help to connect with a lender or county office for answers to your questions?"

Keep it specific. Follow up when promised, and record the client's preferred timing and next step.

Discussion: share a real client scenario

Share a real client scenario, with no names. Three questions guide the conversation:

- Which client will you help first before year-end?
- Which holiday objection is hardest for you to answer?
- How will you explain December 31 without promising a result?

One volunteer's scenario is worked through together using the scripts in this guide.

Complete this sentence out loud

Each agent closes the working session by saying:

> *"By [date], I'll contact [client] to help them compare [specific options], and our next step will be [specific action]."*

The goal is one clear action: contact one priority client this week and agree on a next step before December 31.

Tool tip: Hynri social posting

Hynri can help with the holiday marketing you just planned. It schedules your posts to Buffer and Metricool, with Google Business, SEO and AEO built in, and content written for your market. The benefit is consistent holiday posting that helps buyers and sellers find you, without starting from a blank page.

Try it: "Write and schedule a week of holiday posts for my market."

Thank you

FOR LEADING WITH VALUE THIS SEASON



Your Success Is My Mission!

Scott Barrett

BROKER · FLORIDA LUXURY REALTY

FLORIDA *Luxury* REALTY